

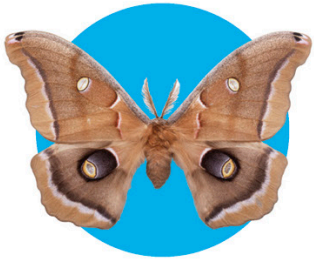


SUCCESS



Look, but don't touch

If you want to stay hidden then drab colors, such as browns and grays, are your best option. However, if you want to be noticed, the brighter you are, the better. Species that are poisonous or taste bad have striking colors that act as a warning. Red, white, yellow, and black usually mean "don't come near me."



Distraction

Bright colors are also used as a distraction. Some butterflies and coral reef fish have circles of color on their wings or at the rear end of their body that look like eyes. Predators think they are attacking the head, which gives the animal a chance to get away without suffering too much damage.

CHANGE OF COLOR

Some animals are capable of changing color. Arctic hares (pictured) do this seasonally, swapping their dull summer coloring for pure white in the winter



SUMMER

so they are hidden against the snow. Others, such as squid and chameleons, can change at will, using color to show their mood or to court a mate. Many lizards change to help them absorb or lose heat.



WINTER

these are the **MASTERS OF DISGUISE...**



FLOWER MANTIS



BEE ORCHID

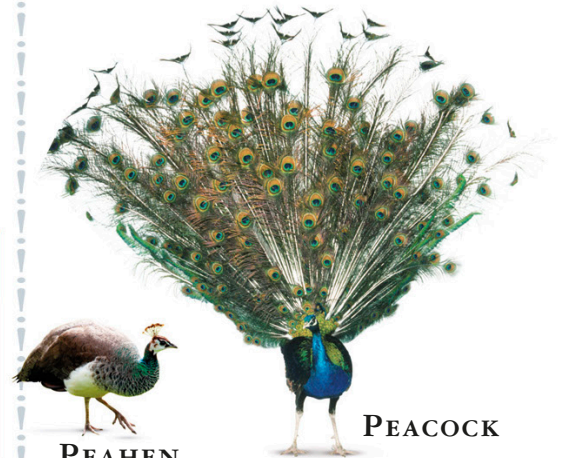
The bee orchid has flowers that look like a female bee, which attracts male bees. The male tries to mate with the "female," fertilizing the flower in the process.



HOVERFLY

FLASHY DRESSERS

Color is used by many species to attract rather than repel. In many cases it is the male that is the gaudier—females are usually dull by comparison.



PEAHEN

PEACOCK

The main purpose is to attract a mate, so the brighter, the better. Those that are strongest and healthiest tend to have the best coloration and methods of displaying it, so they will attract more females. Female peafowl (peahens) are attracted to male birds that have more "eyes" on their tails than their rivals.

As well as color, other impressive attributes—such as a large set of antlers—can attract a mate.



RED
DEER
STAG